

# fn peel\_permute\_and\_flip

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This proof resides in “**contrib**” because it has not completed the vetting process.

This document proves soundness of `peel_permute_and_flip` in `mod.rs` at commit `e62b0aa2` (outdated<sup>1</sup>). `peel_permute_and_flip` noisily selects the index of the greatest score from a vector of input scores  $k$  times without replacement.

## 1 Hoare Triple

### Precondition

### Compiler-verified

*Types consistent with pseudocode.*

### Caller-verified

None

### Pseudocode

```
1 def peel_permute_and_flip(  
2     x: list[RBig],  
3     scale: RBig,  
4     k: usize,  
5     replacement: bool,  
6 ):  
7     natural_order = []  
8     sorted_order = BTreeSet.new()  
9  
10    for _ in range(min(k, x.len())):  
11        index = permute_and_flip(x, scale, replacement) #  
12        x.remove(index) #  
13  
14        # map index on modified x back to original x (postprocessing)  
15        for del_ in sorted_order: # |  
16            if del_ <= index:  
17                index += 1  
18            else:  
19                break  
20  
21        sorted_order.insert(index)  
22        natural_order.push(index)  
23
```

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<sup>1</sup>See new changes with `git diff e62b0aa2..f5824f2 rust/src/measurements/noisy_top_k/mod.rs`

## Postcondition

**Theorem 1.1.**     • If replacement is set, returns a sample from  $\mathcal{M}_{EM}$  (as defined in MS2023 Definition 4), otherwise returns a sample from  $\mathcal{M}_{PF}$  (as defined in MS2023 Lemma 1),  $k$  times by peeling, where  $\text{scale} = \frac{2 \cdot \Delta}{\epsilon}$ .

- Errors are data-independent, except for exhaustion of entropy.

*Proof.* The pseudocode applies `permute_and_flip` on line 11 up to  $k$  times (no greater than the number of scores), each time removing the selected score on line 12.

Since the index in subsequent selections may be offset by an earlier removal, a data-independent post-processing of the index is performed on line 15.

The only source of error is due to entropy exhaustion. □